Microsoft Cloud Forensic Evidence Acquisition

PowerShell Reference for Microsoft Cloud and Endpoint Evidence

How can an investigator acquire or query each Microsoft evidence source with PowerShell?

10 evidence sources · 8 Microsoft products · 154 official Microsoft references
Checked against Microsoft Learn on 2026-10-13

PowerShell acquisition cannot recreate telemetry that was never generated, enabled, collected, retained, or made accessible to the investigator.

No evidence does not automatically mean no activity occurred.

COMMAND TAGS

ACQUIRE	Acquires evidence
INSPECT	Inspects configuration
CHANGES CONFIG	Changes configuration
CONNECT	Authenticates session

Interface status follows each command name: GA, Current, Beta, Preview, Retiring. Beta and preview interfaces can change without notice.

VERIFICATION STATUS

✓ Verified	Every field checked against current Microsoft documentation
! Conditional	Usable, with listed gaps still to confirm
? Verification required	Not yet confirmed; do not rely on it
✕ Deprecated or replaced	Retiring or replaced; use the named successor

"Verification required" marks a value Microsoft documentation did not confirm. Test it before relying on it.

AVAILABILITY LEGEND

AUTO	Evidence is generated or collected automatically
CONFIG	Auditing, collection, telemetry, or a feature must be configured
EXPORT	Native evidence can be exported or routed
LICENSE	Availability depends on licensing
DEPLOY	Product deployment or onboarding is required
POLICY	Evidence detail depends on an audit or logging policy
ON DEMAND	Evidence is produced only when requested
SUPPORTING	Contextual evidence rather than a primary audit trail

2 Microsoft Graph

Microsoft Graph PowerShell for Microsoft Entra activity logs and other Graph resources.

01 ENTRA ID · ✓ Verified

Audit logs

ACQUISITION METHOD Microsoft Graph PowerShell
API Microsoft Graph (audit logs API) (GA)
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `Microsoft Graph PowerShell`, `Microsoft.Graph.Reports`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
CONNECT **Connect-MgGraph** Current

```
Connect-MgGraph -Scopes "AuditLog.Read.All","Directory.Read.All"
```

Add Policy.Read.ConditionalAccess when Conditional Access details are needed.

ACQUIRE **Get-MgAuditLogDirectoryAudit** GA

```
Get-MgAuditLogDirectoryAudit -Filter "activityDateTime ge 2026-10-01T00:00:00Z and activityDateTime le 2026-10-07T23:59:59Z" -All
```

Paging and limits: -All follows every page; -Top and -PageSize bound the result. activityDateTime supports eq, ge, and le in $filter, and $orderby.
Other documented filters: activityDisplayName (eq, startswith), correlationId (eq), loggedByService (eq), initiatedBy/user/id, initiatedBy/user/userPrincipalName, and initiatedBy/app/appId.

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- **Microsoft Graph (application):** AuditLog.Read.All (least privileged); Directory.Read.All (higher privileged)
- **Microsoft Graph (delegated):** AuditLog.Read.All (least privileged); Directory.Read.All (higher privileged)
- **Microsoft Entra role:** Reports Reader (least privileged), Security Reader, or Security Administrator to read audit logs
- **Microsoft Entra role:** Attribute Log Reader or Attribute Log Administrator for custom security attribute audit logs
- **Microsoft Entra role:** Security Administrator (least privileged to configure Microsoft Entra diagnostic settings)

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
AUTO LICENSE EXPORT **Automatic with limited native retention**
Generated without configuration.
Native retention: 7 days (Microsoft Entra ID Free); 30 days (Microsoft Entra ID P1 or P2)

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT JSON CSV

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- Native retention is 7 or 30 days. Without a diagnostic setting in place before the incident, older records cannot be recovered.
- Custom security attribute audit logs and provisioning logs are only on the Microsoft Graph beta endpoint.
- Audit logs are available only for features the tenant has licensed.
- The IP address in an audit record is the OAuth client's IP address (the TCP peer of the service endpoint), not necessarily the end user's device.

01 ENTRA ID · ! Conditional · 1 open gap

Sign-in logs

ACQUISITION METHOD Microsoft Graph PowerShell
API Microsoft Graph (GA)
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `Microsoft Graph PowerShell`, `Microsoft.Graph.Reports`, `Microsoft.Graph.Beta.Reports`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
CONNECT **Connect-MgGraph** Current

```
Connect-MgGraph -Scopes "AuditLog.Read.All","Directory.Read.All"
```

Directory.Read.All is needed alongside AuditLog.Read.All to avoid intermittent premium-license errors.

ACQUIRE **Get-MgAuditLogSignIn** GA

```
Get-MgAuditLogSignIn -Filter "createdDateTime ge 2026-10-01T00:00:00Z and createdDateTime le 2026-10-07T23:59:59Z"
```

Paging and limits: Maximum and default page size is 1,000; most recent first. Filter on a time range to avoid timeouts.
The v1.0 API returns interactive user sign-ins (and successful federated sign-ins) only.

ACQUIRE **Get-MgBetaAuditLogSignIn** Beta

```
Get-MgBetaAuditLogSignIn -Filter "(createdDateTime ge 2026-10-01T00:00:00Z and createdDateTime le 2026-10-07T23:59:59Z) and signInEventTypes/any(t: t eq 'nonInteractiveUser')"
```

Paging and limits: Verification required
Beta APIs are subject to change and aren't supported for production. Without an event-type filter the API returns interactive user sign-ins only.

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- **Microsoft Graph (application):** AuditLog.Read.All (least privileged); add Directory.Read.All to avoid intermittent license-check errors
- **Microsoft Graph (application):** Policy.Read.ConditionalAccess (or Policy.Read.All) to receive appliedConditionalAccessPolicies
- **Microsoft Entra role:** Global Reader, Reports Reader, Security Administrator, Security Operator, or Security Reader (delegated access)

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
AUTO LICENSE EXPORT **Automatic with limited native retention**
Generated without configuration.
Native retention: 7 days (Microsoft Entra ID Free); 30 days (Microsoft Entra ID P1 or P2)

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT JSON CSV

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- Without a signInEventTypes filter, the List signIns API returns only interactive user sign-ins; the other three types require the beta endpoint.
- Only sign-ins within the Microsoft Entra default retention period are available through the API.
- appliedConditionalAccessPolicies is omitted when the caller cannot read Conditional Access data.
- Each sign-in type is a separate diagnostic-setting category; routing only SignInLogs leaves the other three types uncollected.

4 Windows Eventing

Event channels read on the device and exported with their original structure.

SHARED BY SEVERAL SOURCES IN THIS PATH

Required permissions
- **Azure RBAC:** Monitoring Reader (run log queries in the workspace) when events are collected centrally
- **Local Windows privilege:** Run elevated (Administrator). Get-WinEvent documents errors retrieving log information when not run as Administrator.

Paging and limits
- -MaxEvents limits results.

05 POWERSHELL · ✓ Verified

PowerShell Operational logs (script block and module logging)

ACQUISITION METHOD Windows Eventing
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `Microsoft.PowerShell.Diagnostics`, `Windows command-line tool`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
ACQUIRE **Get-WinEvent** Current

```
Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable @{ LogName='Microsoft-Windows-PowerShell/Operational'; Id=4104 }
```

Paging and limits: see the shared box for this path.

ACQUIRE **Get-WinEvent** Current

```
Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable @{ LogName='PowerShellCore/Operational'; Id=4104 }
```

Paging and limits: see the shared box for this path.

ACQUIRE **wevtutil epl** Current

```
wevtutil epl Microsoft-Windows-PowerShell/Operational C:\Evidence\PowerShell-Operational.evtx
```

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- Plus the shared permissions for this path

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
CONFIG POLICY EXPORT **Auditing policy dependent**
Enable 'Turn on PowerShell Script Block Logging' through Group Policy (Windows Components > Windows PowerShell for 5.1; Administrative Templates > PowerShell Core for 7), the policy registry key, or the MDM Policy CSP (WindowsPowerShell/TurnOnPowerShellScriptBlockLogging).
Native retention: Size-bound local log. Microsoft troubleshooting guidance for Azure VMs gives 15,728,640 bytes as the default maximum size of Microsoft-Windows-PowerShell/Operational.

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT EVTX JSON CSV

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- If script block logging was not enabled when the activity occurred, no script content was recorded.
- Scripts larger than the maximum event message size are split across several 4104 events; reassemble them before analysis.
- Invocation logging (start and stop events) produces a high volume of events.
- The PowerShell 7 channel exists only after its event provider is registered.

05 WINDOWS · ✓ Verified

Security event log

ACQUISITION METHOD Windows Eventing
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `Microsoft.PowerShell.Diagnostics`, `Windows command-line tool`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
ACQUIRE **Get-WinEvent** Current

```
Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable @{ LogName='Security'; Id=4688; StartTime=(Get-Date).AddDays(-1) }
```

Paging and limits: -MaxEvents limits results; newest first by default (-Oldest reverses).
Get-WinEvent replaces Get-EventLog on Windows Vista and later.

ACQUIRE **wevtutil epl** Current

```
wevtutil epl Security C:\Evidence\Security.evtx
```

Use /q:<Query> to export a subset.

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- Plus the shared permissions for this path

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
POLICY EXPORT **Auditing policy dependent**
Audit categories are enabled by basic or advanced audit policy.
Native retention: Size-bound local log. Microsoft troubleshooting guidance for Azure VMs gives 20,971,520 bytes as the default maximum size of the Security log.

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT EVTX JSON CSV

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- If an audit setting was not enabled when the activity occurred, those events were never generated.
- Size-bound: the time span retained depends on log size and event volume.
- Command lines in 4688 events can contain passwords or other secrets; handle exports accordingly.

07 DEFENDER ANTIVIRUS · ✓ Verified

Microsoft-Windows-Windows Defender/Operational event log

ACQUISITION METHOD Windows Eventing
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `Microsoft.PowerShell.Diagnostics`, `Windows command-line tool`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
ACQUIRE **Get-WinEvent** Current

```
Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable @{ LogName='Microsoft-Windows-Windows Defender/Operational'; Id=1116,1117,5007 }
```

Paging and limits: see the shared box for this path.

ACQUIRE **wevtutil epl** Current

```
wevtutil epl "Microsoft-Windows-Windows Defender/Operational" C:\Evidence\Defender-Operational.evtx
```

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- Plus the shared permissions for this path

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
AUTO EXPORT **Automatic**
Written while Defender Antivirus runs.
Native retention: Size-bound local log; default size not documented in reviewed sources

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT EVTX JSON CSV

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- When ThreatSeverityDefaultAction is None, a 1116 detection is followed by a 1117 with an Allow action: detected but not remediated.
- Local evidence only. On devices onboarded to Defender for Endpoint, compare with cloud telemetry and alerts.

08 DEFENDER FOR ENDPOINT · ✓ Verified

Microsoft-Windows-SENSE/Operational event log

ACQUISITION METHOD Windows Eventing
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `Microsoft.PowerShell.Diagnostics`, `Windows command-line tool`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
ACQUIRE **Get-WinEvent** Current

```
Get-WinEvent -LogName 'Microsoft-Windows-SENSE/Operational'
```

Paging and limits: see the shared box for this path.

ACQUIRE **wevtutil epl** Current

```
wevtutil epl Microsoft-Windows-SENSE/Operational C:\Evidence\SENSE-Operational.evtx
```

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- Plus the shared permissions for this path

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
DEPLOY SUPPORTING **Deployment dependent**
Central collection: an Azure Monitor Agent data collection rule with a Windows events data source sends the selected events to the Event table.
Native retention: Size-bound local log; default size not documented in reviewed sources

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT EVTX JSON CSV

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- Records sensor health only, not endpoint activity or detections.
- Some Defender for Endpoint events also appear in the System event log.

5 Microsoft Graph Security and Defender interfaces

Defender XDR incidents and alerts and advanced hunting through the Microsoft Graph security API.

08 DEFENDER FOR ENDPOINT · ✓ Verified

Advanced hunting device tables (endpoint telemetry)

ACQUISITION METHOD Microsoft Graph Security API
API Microsoft Graph security API (runHuntingQuery) (GA)
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `Microsoft Graph PowerShell`, `Microsoft.Graph.Security`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
CONNECT **Connect-MgGraph** Current

```
Connect-MgGraph -Scopes "ThreatHunting.Read.All"
```

ACQUIRE **Start-MgSecurityHuntingQuery** GA

```
Start-MgSecurityHuntingQuery -Query "DeviceProcessEvents | where InitiatingProcessFileName == 'powershell.exe' | where ProcessCommandLine contains 'appdata' | project Timestamp, FileName, InitiatingProcessFileName, DeviceId | limit 2" -Timespan "P30D"
```

Paging and limits: No paging. Up to 100,000 rows and 50 MB per result; requests over 3 minutes time out; HTTP 429 when the tenant quota is reached.
Timespan defaults to 30 days. If both the query and Timespan set a time filter, the shorter span applies.

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- **Microsoft Graph (application):** ThreatHunting.Read.All
- **Microsoft Graph (delegated):** ThreatHunting.Read.All

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
DEPLOY LICENSE EXPORT **Deployment dependent**
Devices must be onboarded to Defender for Endpoint.
Native retention: Advanced hunting returns data from the past 30 days

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT JSON CSV

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- 30-day lookback in advanced hunting.
- Per-query limits: 100,000 rows and 50 MB; 3-minute time-out; tenant CPU quotas.
- Advanced hunting data is in UTC.
- Data stored only in the Microsoft Sentinel data lake isn't available in advanced hunting.
- Only signals from onboarded devices exist.
- Defender for Endpoint detection is not an auditing or logging solution that records every operation; the sensor throttles high rates of repeated identical events.
- Behavioral telemetry is stored for six months; advanced hunting queries cover 30 days.

13 DEFENDER XDR · ✓ Verified

Incidents and alerts

ACQUISITION METHOD Microsoft Graph Security API
API Microsoft Graph security API (GA)
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `Microsoft Graph PowerShell`, `Microsoft.Graph.Security`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
CONNECT **Connect-MgGraph** Current

```
Connect-MgGraph -Scopes "SecurityIncident.Read.All","SecurityAlert.Read.All"
```

ACQUIRE **Get-MgSecurityIncident** GA

```
Get-MgSecurityIncident -ExpandProperty "alerts"
```

Paging and limits: @odata.nextLink; supports $top, $skip, $filter, $count, and $expand.
$filter supports assignedTo, classification, createdDateTime, determination, lastUpdateDateTime, severity, and status.

ACQUIRE **Get-MgSecurityAlertV2** GA

```
Get-MgSecurityAlertV2
```

Paging and limits: @odata.nextLink; supports $top, $skip, $filter, and $count. Filterable properties: assignedTo, classification, determination, createdDateTime, lastUpdateDateTime, severity, serviceSource, and status.

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- **Microsoft Graph (application):** SecurityIncident.Read.All (incidents); SecurityAlert.Read.All (alerts)
- **Microsoft Entra role:** Security Reader, Global Reader, Security Operator, or Security Administrator (delegated access)

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
LICENSE DEPLOY EXPORT **Licensing dependent**
Contributing Defender products must be deployed, for example devices onboarded to Defender for Endpoint.
Native retention: Alerts are returned within the environment's retention policy; a fixed value is not documented in reviewed sources

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT JSON

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- Alerts and incidents are detection outputs. No alert does not mean no activity occurred.
- Only signals from licensed and provisioned products are correlated.

14 SENTINEL · ! Conditional · 1 open gap

Microsoft Sentinel analytics, alerts, and incidents

ACQUISITION METHOD Microsoft Graph Security API
API Microsoft Graph security API (alerts_v2) (GA)
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `Microsoft.Graph.Security`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
ACQUIRE **Get-MgSecurityAlertV2** GA

```
Get-MgSecurityAlertV2 -Filter "serviceSource eq 'microsoftSentinel'"
```

Paging and limits: @odata.nextLink; supports $top, $skip, $filter, and $count.

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- **Microsoft Graph (application):** SecurityAlert.Read.All
- **Azure RBAC:** Microsoft Sentinel Reader (view data and incidents and query Sentinel tables); Microsoft Sentinel Responder adds incident management

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
DEPLOY CONFIG **Deployment dependent**
A workspace must be onboarded to Sentinel, with data connectors and analytics rules configured.
Native retention: Governed by the underlying Log Analytics workspace and table settings

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT JSON CSV

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- After March 31, 2027, Sentinel is no longer supported in the Azure portal; it is available only in the Microsoft Defender portal.
- Sentinel analytics see only data routed to the workspace.
- Data stored only in the Sentinel data lake isn't available in Defender advanced hunting.

6 Microsoft 365 Audit interfaces

Bounded interactive searches (Search-UnifiedAuditLog), asynchronous Graph audit searches, and the Management Activity API feed for programmatic download.

10 PURVIEW AUDIT · ! Conditional · 1 open gap

Unified audit log

ACQUISITION METHOD Exchange Online PowerShell
API Office 365 Management Activity API (Microsoft's recommendation for programmatic download); Microsoft Graph Audit Search API (GA)
POWERSHELL MODULE OR INTERFACE `ExchangeOnlineManagement`, `Exchange Online PowerShell`, `Microsoft.Graph.Security`, `Office 365 Management Activity API`

CMDLET, API, OR QUERY MECHANISM
CONNECT **Connect-ExchangeOnline** Current

```
Connect-ExchangeOnline -UserPrincipalName <admin-upn>
```

Install or update the module with Install-Module/Update-Module -Name ExchangeOnlineManagement. Connect-IPPSSession connects to Security & Compliance PowerShell instead.

ACQUIRE **Search-UnifiedAuditLog** Current

```
$sid = [guid]::NewGuid().ToString(); Search-UnifiedAuditLog -StartDate 2026-10-01 -EndDate 2026-10-07 -SessionId $sid -SessionCommand ReturnLargeSet -ResultSize 5000
```

Paging and limits: Default returns up to 100 records. ReturnLargeSet: unsorted, up to 50,000 results per search, 5,000 per page. ReturnNextPreviewPage: sorted, up to 5,000. Don't mix SessionCommand values within one SessionId. Split larger searches.
Filters include -UserIds, -Operations, -RecordType, -IPAddresses, -ObjectIds, -SiteIds, and -FreeText. ReturnLargeSet output can contain duplicates; de-duplicate and sort afterwards.

ACQUIRE **New-MgSecurityAuditLogQuery** GA

```
$q = New-MgSecurityAuditLogQuery -DisplayName "<case-id> audit search" -FilterStartDateTime ([datetime]"2026-10-01T00:00:00Z") -FilterEndDateTime ([datetime]"2026-10-07T23:59:59Z") -RecordTypeFilters "exchangeItem"
```

The query runs asynchronously; its status moves through notStarted, running, and succeeded (or failed or cancelled). Other filters: operations, user principal names, IP addresses, object IDs, administrative units, keyword, and service. Tenant-level daily submission and concurrent-query limits apply.

ACQUIRE **Get-MgSecurityAuditLogQueryRecord** GA

```
Get-MgSecurityAuditLogQueryRecord -AuditLogQueryId $q.Id
```

Paging and limits: Verification required
Records include createdDateTime, auditLogRecordType, operation, userPrincipalName, clientIp, objectId, service, and the workload-specific auditData object.

ACQUIRE **Invoke-WebRequest** Current

```
Invoke-WebRequest -Method GET -Headers $headerParams -Uri "https://manage.office.com/api/v1.0/<tenant-id>/activity/feed/subscriptions/content?contentType=Audit.SharePoint&startTime=2026-10-01T00:00&endTime=2026-10-01T23:59&PublisherIdentifier=<tenant-id>"
```

Paging and limits: Results are truncated when large; follow the NextPageUri response header until it is absent. startTime and endTime must both be set (or both omitted), be no more than 24 hours apart, and start no more than 7 days in the past.
$headerParams holds a Microsoft Entra access token with the ActivityFeed.Read permission. A subscription to the content type must already exist (/subscriptions/start); the first content can take up to 12 hours to appear. Include PublisherIdentifier on every call, including content downloads, to avoid shared throttling.

REQUIRED PERMISSIONS
- **Exchange Online / Purview role:** View-Only Audit Logs or Audit Logs
- **Microsoft Graph (application):** Audit Search API: a workload-scoped permission (AuditLogsQuery-Entra.Read.All, -Exchange.Read.All, -SharePoint.Read.All, -OneDrive.Read.All, -CRM.Read.All, -Endpoint.Read.All) or AuditLogsQuery.Read.All; the same permissions apply to delegated access
- **Office 365 Management Activity API:** ActivityFeed.Read (Read activity data for an organization); DLP sensitive data needs the separate Read DLP sensitive data permission

PRIOR-COLLECTION REQUIREMENT
AUTO LICENSE POLICY EXPORT **Automatic**
Audit (Standard) is enabled by default for most organizations, but unified audit log ingestion can be turned off (Set-AdminAuditLogConfig -UnifiedAuditLogIngestionEnabled $false).
Native retention: 180 days (Audit Standard); 1 year by default for Microsoft Entra ID, Exchange, OneDrive, and SharePoint records of Audit (Premium) users

RECOMMENDED OUTPUT FORMAT JSON CSV

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS
- Microsoft recommends the Office 365 Management Activity API, not Search-UnifiedAuditLog scripts, for programmatically downloading audit data.
- Search-UnifiedAuditLog returns 100 records by default; ReturnLargeSet results are unsorted and can contain duplicates.
- Mailbox audit events for some users may not appear in searches even with mailbox auditing on by default.
- Search-UnifiedAuditLog returns no results in Office 365 operated by 21Vianet.
- Retention depends on the license of the user who performed the activity.
- The Management Activity API is a feed, not a historical search: content can be listed only for the last 7 days, events within a blob aren't in occurrence order, and nothing is available for a content type until a subscription exists.
- If unified audit logging is off, the Management Activity API returns an error rather than data.

RECORD EVERY ACQUISITION

- Source system and scope: tenant, subscription, workspace, resource, or device
- Query or filter used, including the time range
- UTC acquisition start and end time
- Collecting account or application identity, and its permission context
- Tool, module, or API name and version
- Original output format and any export format
- How pagination and result limits were handled
- Errors, throttling, and retries
- Known completeness limitations
- Hash of every file produced (for example, SHA-256)

Preserve structured raw results before creating summaries. An export mechanism does not establish legal chain of custody by itself.

OUTPUT FORMATS

JSON	APIs and structured cloud results; keeps nested properties
CSV	Analyst-friendly tables; flatten only after keeping the raw JSON
EVTX	Windows event channels in their original form
CLIXML	Only when PowerShell object fidelity matters
TXT	Human-readable supporting output, never the sole evidence format

This is an independent investigator-focused reference based on publicly available Microsoft documentation. Microsoft product capabilities, licensing, APIs, retention, and log schemas can change. Always verify current behavior in official Microsoft documentation. Not an official Microsoft publication.